Devin Hacks Kochi Tracks

Four directions for building something useful, perceptive, resilient or fun.

1. KILL THE BUSYWORK

Build something that takes an annoying, repetitive job off someone’s hands. Pick a real workflow and complete it, rather than just telling the user what to do.

> Think: a tool that turns scattered event registrations into a usable check-in system, or a scanner that handles stock-taking for a small shop.

2. MAKE THE INVISIBLE VISIBLE

Build something that helps people notice what they normally miss, and do something useful with that information.

> Think: software that reveals where a team’s work keeps getting stuck, or a sensor that spots a water leak before someone notices the damage. The interesting part is what happens after detection.

3. WORKS ANYWAY

Build for the conditions most products ignore: unreliable internet, an old phone, a language barrier, or someone who can’t use a conventional interface. Choose one constraint and make your product work despite it. Demo it with the constraint actually present.

> Think: an offline coordination tool for field teams, or a tactile controller that makes an everyday device easier to use.

4. MAKE ROOM FOR PLAY

Build something people would want to experience, not just get work done with. Create a new way to play, make music, tell stories or interact with other people.

> Think: a game played across everyone’s phones in the room, an interactive story whose world responds to players, or a musical instrument controlled through movement.